Global Centre for Rehumanising Democracy

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Syed Muhammed Shariq
Department of Computer Science
Dawood University of Engineering and Technology
Karachi, Pakistan

Internship Placement as Research Intern, Democracy Discourse Index (DDI) Pakistan

Dear Syed,

On behalf of the Global Centre for Rehumanising Democracy (GCRD), I am pleased to offer you an internship placement as a Junior Researcher/Student Researcher/Research Intern on the Democracy Discourse Index (DDI) Pakistan, a part of a multicountry UNDESA-catalogued research project. Your selection reflects your academic standing and your readiness to contribute to serious public-interest research.

1. About the Democracy Discourse Index

The DDI is a longitudinal, human-validated and AI-assisted system for measuring democratic health through the quality of public discourse. Established democracy indices largely assess elections, laws and institutions. The DDI looks at how democracy is lived in public conversation. It analyses public comments on defined topics using twenty behavioural indicators across four dimensions: **Empathy**, **Civility**, **Trust Language** and **Democratic Agency**.

The current phase of DDI Pakistan asks whether the democratic quality of social media discussion differs depending on whether a conversation is started by a mainstream media organisation or by a social media influencer or digital public figure. The unit of analysis is the individual public comment.

Your work matters beyond the classroom. Each comment in the study is independently coded by three trained human coders. This triple-coding provides the ground truth for GCRD's ReHuman AI system, which then codes the wider corpus at scale and produces national scores. The quality and care of your coding therefore directly shapes the reliability of Pakistan's national DDI results.

2. Terms of Placement

Item	Detail
Position	Junior Researcher/Student Researcher/Research Intern, DDI Pakistan
Host organisation	Global Centre for Rehumanising Democracy (GCRD), United Kingdom
Your institution	Dawood University of Engineering and Technology, Karachi
Start date	12 September 2026
End date	8 weeks (extendable up to 15 December 2026)
Expected commitment	96+ hours, or as agreed upon with the supervisor
Mode	[Remote / hybrid], with scheduled online sessions
GCRD supervisor	Dr. Wajiha Raza Rizvi
Remuneration	None. This is an unpaid academic placement.

3. Responsibilities

As a Research Intern, you will:

1. Complete DDI training on the methodology, the codebook and research ethics before beginning live coding.
2. Independently code your assigned public comments using the validated DDI codebook, applying the 0 to 4 scale across all twenty indicators.
3. Take part in calibration and reliability rounds. Intercoder reliability is measured with Krippendorff's alpha, where 0.70 is acceptable and 0.75 is the standard we aim for.
4. Attend adjudication meetings to resolve coding disagreements with your group, and record the reasoning behind your judgements.
5. Meet all coding and submission deadlines set by your faculty supervisor and the GCRD team. Complete a minimum of six coding assignments and write one brief. The weekly hours or individual assignment completion time may vary, based on your comprehension and efficiency.
6. Contribute, with your group, to a short policy brief that argues a clear thesis from the data, for possible publication on the Discourse Observatory (discourseobservatory.org).
7. Propose an online source of media, influencer, or user comments for data collection for Pakistan to your GCRD supervisor when possible.

4. What You Will Gain

- Training in a rigorous, human-in-the-loop method for measuring democratic discourse, used across a growing international network of university partners.
- Practical experience in content analysis, intercoder reliability, data adjudication and evidence-based policy writing.

- Insight into how human judgement and AI systems work together responsibly at scale.
- Named credit as a contributor on any policy brief you help write.
- A **GCRD Certificate of Completion** on satisfactory completion of the internship.

5. Ethics, Confidentiality and Data Protection

The DDI studies publicly available comments, but the people who wrote them deserve respect. You agree to:

- Use DDI data only for the purposes of this project.
- Not copy, share, publish or post any raw data, coding workbooks or unpublished results outside the project team.
- Not identify, contact, or draw public attention to any individual commenter.
- Code with impartiality, setting aside your own political, religious or partisan views. The DDI is an observatory, not an arbiter.
- Keep all project materials secure and return or delete them at the end of the internship as instructed.

Some comments you code may be hostile, offensive or distressing. If the material affects you, please tell your faculty supervisor or the GCRD team. You may step back from a batch without any penalty.

6. Intellectual Property and Publication

The DDI methodology, codebook, data and coding outputs remain the property of GCRD. Published outputs will credit contributing interns by name. Any public use of DDI findings, including on social media, requires prior approval from GCRD.

7. Conduct and Completion

You are expected to uphold the academic integrity policies of Dawood University of Engineering and Technology and the standards of conduct expected by GCRD. Coding must be your own independent work. The use of AI tools to produce or suggest your codes is not permitted, as it would compromise the human ground truth on which the index depends.

The internship is considered complete when you have finished training, submitted your assigned coding to the required standard, and contributed to your group's brief. Either party may end this placement by giving written notice to the other and to your faculty supervisor.

8. Nature of the Placement

This internship is an academic placement undertaken as part of your studies at Dawood University of Engineering and Technology. It does not create a contract of employment or an employment relationship between you and GCRD, and it confers no entitlement to a salary, employment benefits or future employment.

No salary, stipend or honorarium is payable for this placement. You remain a student of Dawood University throughout the placement and are subject to its academic regulations.

9. Acceptance

Your online registration amounts to acceptance.

Please also confirm your acceptance by signing below and returning a copy to your faculty supervisor.

We are glad to welcome you to this work. Democracy is renewed in the ordinary ways people speak to and about one another, and you will be helping to measure what is often left unseen.

With warm regards,



Dr Jacob Udo-Udo Jacob
Founding Executive Director
Global Centre for Rehumanising Democracy

Intern's Acceptance

I, **……**, accept the internship placement as Research Intern on the Democracy Discourse Index Pakistan on the terms set out in this letter, including the ethics, confidentiality and data protection commitments in Section 5 and the nature of the placement set out in Section 8.

Signature: _____

Date: _____